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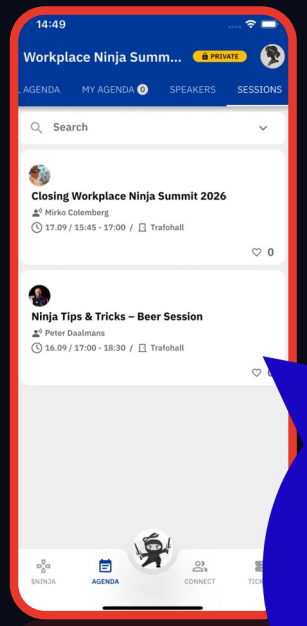
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Welcome on stage

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Session

Deletion Happens –
Are you Ready for Recovery in Entra ID?

Community Stage
room check-in

Speaker

Klaus Bierschenk
CGI Germany, Microsoft Security MVP

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About Klaus Bierschenk

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Focus

Identity / Security

From

Murnau / Germany (1h south of Munich)

My Blog

https://Nothingbutcloud.net



Certifications

Microsoft® Most Valuable Professional

Azure Infra & Entra ID SÜDDEUTSCHLAND

Hobbies

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Trust is good, backup is better!
So, what's our topic today?

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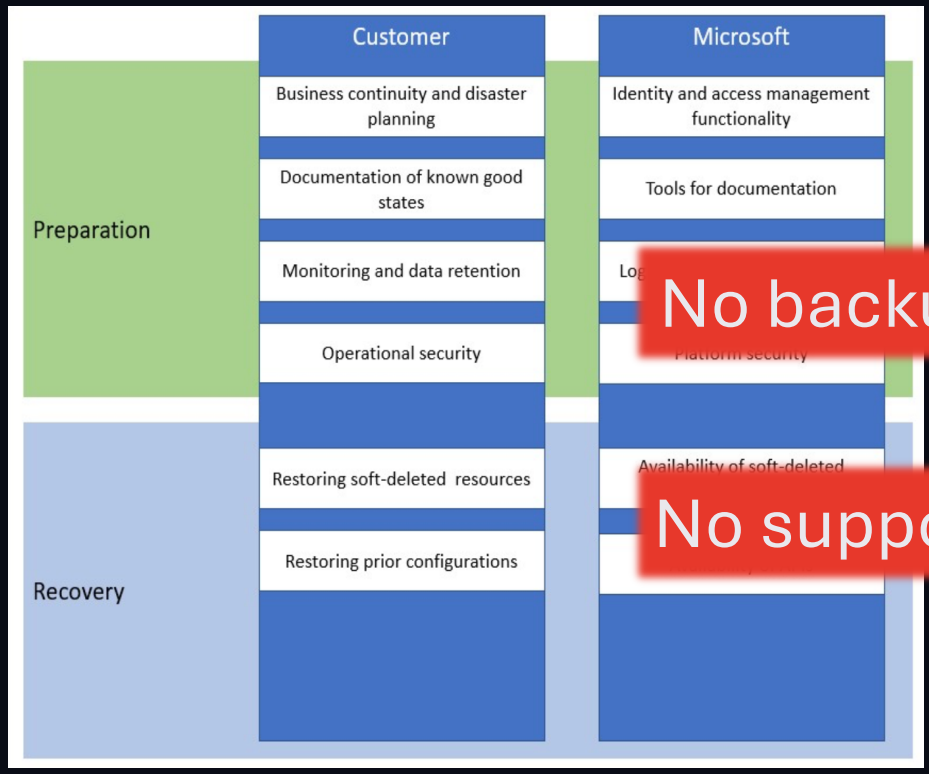
- Microsoft's position on backup and restore in Entra ID?
- How can we back up Entra ID? Or should we rather ask: what can actually be restored?
- Security: How can we prevent object or configuration loss in Entra ID?

No commercials inside

MS standpoint on backup / restore in Entra ID

Microsoft provides platform & APIs

Customer responsible for planning & restoring



https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/architecture/recoverability-overview

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Prioritize your crown jewels

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- *Knowing* **what is really important -** otherwise a recovery concept becomes difficult

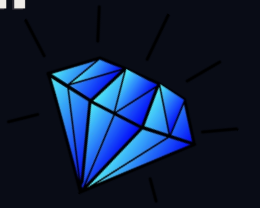
- Every company is different, every Entra ID Tenant is different – not everything is always equally critical
  (e.g. when a Tenant has Security Defaults enabled, backing up CAs is not the major topic)

- Sometimes proper documentation is enough. Sometimes a backup procedure is the better choice
  (e.g. with +50 CA policies, documentation alone is not sufficient)



Many settings. Which ones really matter?

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User Management & Settings
User roles & permissions
Default sign-in options for users
User lifecycle policies
Locked account policies
User sign-in & session policies
Policies for secondary email addresses
User sign-in logs & auditing
Management of authentication methods
Self-service user registration

Authentication & Security
Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) policies
Passwordless authentication (FIDO2, Windows Hello)
Certificate-based authentication
Token lifetimes & session configuration
Continuous Access Evaluation (CAE)
Risk-based authentication
Identity risk policies
Authentication strengths for external users
Adaptive authentication policies

Password Policies & Password Protection
Password length & complexity requirements
Password expiration period
Banned password policy (custom deny list)
Smart lockout policy (failed sign-in attempts)
Self-Service Password Reset (SSPR) policies
Security questions for SSPR
Temporary Access Pass policies
Advanced password protection policies for on-premises AD

Global Secure Access (GSA)
Network access policies
Condition Access for network connections
Configur network segments
Access apps
Traffic f
Assign
Zero Trust N
Web content filtering
DNS security policies
Logging & monitoring for network access

Global Secure Access (GSA)

Group Management
Dynamic group policies
Group-based license assignment
Self-service group management policies
Automatic group membership based on attributes

Guest Users & External Collaboration (B2B/B2C)
Guest invitation settings
External identity providers (Google, Facebook, SAML, OpenID)
B2B collaboration policies
Guest user permission policies
Automate external user deletion
Session policies for guest users

Entra Clo ization Settings
Entra Cloud
Attribute ma
Custom exp
Synchronizat
Hybrid synchronization options (
Password Hash Sync)
SCIM synchronization with third-party providers
On-premises directory synchronization (Azure AD Connect)
Custom synchronization rules

Entra Cloud Sync Settings

Conditional Access & Access Control
Policies for users & groups
Device state & compliance-based policie
Session policies & token lifetime
Adaptive access policie
Conditional Acc
Anomaly de
Cross-tenant
Security level
Terms of use p

Conditional Access & Access Control

Security & Monitoring Policies
Security alerts & Identity Protection
Identity protection and risk detection settings
Audit logging for identity activities
Anomaly detection for sign-in attempts
Security assessments & recommendations

Roles & Permissions (RBAC & PIM)
Custom roles & permissions
Least privilege access policies
Time-bound role assignments (Just-In-Time)
Approval workflows for admin roles
Audit logs for privileged roles
Security reviews for highly privileged accounts

Identity Governance & Compliance
Regular access reviews
Automatic deactivation o
Compliance re
Autor
Entitl
Acces

Identity-Governance & Compliance

Device Management & Microsoft Entra Cloud Sync
Register devices in Entra ID (Hybrid Azure AD Join, Azure AD Join)
Device tagging and compliance
Device management for Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android
Enable/disable devices in Entra ID
Device lifecycle management
Configure and manage Entra ID Cloud Sync
Define synchronization filters for groups and users
SCIM synchronization with third-party services
Manage on-premises directory synchronization (Azure AD Connect, Cloud Sync)

Application Management & Access Controls
Add/remove enterprise applications
Enable Single Sign-On (SSO) for applications
Configure App Proxy for legacy applications
Define OAuth and OpenID Connect policies
Configure third-party identity providers
Manage token lifetimes for applications
Define Conditional Access policies for applications
Configure user and group permissions for apps
Set up managed identities for services

Administrative Units (AUs)
Administrative Unit objects
Assign users & groups to A
Role-based acces
Delegated a
Policies for

Administrative Units (AUs)

Tenant Sett izational Policies
Manage tenant and domains
Configure organizational branding
Define privacy policies for identities
Restrictions for multi-tenant organizations
Enable Microsoft Entra ID Governance
Manage Adaptive Application Controls
Conditional Access for tenant-level policies
Control self-service group management

Microsoft Entra Cross-Tenant Access
Policies for cross-tenant collaboration
Manage external access to organizational resources
Define tenant-based authentication rules
Adaptive authentication mechanisms for external users

(just the big picture – not for detailed reading)

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Entra object restore – reality check

Object typ	Soft delete	Restore?
User object	✓	🗑 30d Recycle Bin -> H
Security group	✓	🗑 30d Recycle Bin -> H Preview from Nov `2
M365 group	✓	🗑 30d Recycle Bin -> H
Device object	✓	🗑 30d Recycle Bin -> H Preview since Jun `2
Enterprise Application	✓	🔄 Multi-Tenant -> Dele 🔄 Single-Tenant -> Ap
App Registration	✓	🗑 Recycle Bin (Secret
Administrative Unit	✓	🔄 Deleted Item API (3
Conditional Access	✓	🗑 New since Sept 202

🗑 Restore via Recycle Bin, 🚫 no Restore at all, 🔄 Restore via API

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Entra object restore – reality check

Object typ	Soft delete	Restore?
User object	✓	🗑️ 30d Recycle Bin -> Hard deleted
Security group	✓	🗑️ 30d Recycle Bin -> Hard deleted Preview from Nov `25 and GA since Feb. `26 - Previously: 🚫 No restore 🆘
M365 group	✓	🗑️ 30d Recycle Bin -> Hard deleted
Device object	✓	🗑️ 30d Recycle Bin -> Hard deleted Preview since Jun `26 – Previously 🚫 No restore ⚠️
Enterprise Application	✓	🔄 Multi-Tenant -> Deleted Item API 🔄 Single-Tenant -> App Reg Recycle Bin
App Registration	✓	🗑️ Recycle Bin (Secrets & Certs ✓)
Administrative Unit	✓	🔄 Deleted Item API (30d) -> Hard deleted
Conditional Access	✓	🗑️ New since Sept 2025 Recycle Bin - 🔄 Previously: Deleted Items API only

🗑️ Restore via Recycle Bin, 🚫 no Restore at all, 🔄 Restore via API

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Demo

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Administrative Unit
restore via
Microsoft Graph API



Recover via deletedItems API



URLs:

Enterprise Applications
https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/directory/deletedItems/microsoft.graph.serviceprincipal

Administrative Units
https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/directory/deletedItems/microsoft.graph.administrativeUnit
(Post) https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/directory/deletedItems/Object-ID/restore

Conditional Access Policies
https://graph.microsoft.com/beta/identity/conditionalAccess/deletedItems/policies


I WANT YOU
To protect your
Entra Crown Jewels

How to create a smart and easy backup?

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- → Manually difficult (Entra Admin Center, CSV etc.)
  Code-based approaches are much better
- → PowerShell is your friend
  Some manual tweaking… JSON must be precise – e.g. read-only attributes
- → EntraExporter 3.01 is your better friend
  Download here: Open-Source GitHub

Demo …

- → Check out Backup and Recovery (Preview since Mar `26 and P1/P2 req
  Easy built-in functionality (keep in mind: one backup per day and seven days history max.!)

Demo …

- → Once upon a time there was M365DSC as another great friend
  But now we have Tenant Configuration Management (API GA since May `26) – Entra Admin Center in Preview

Demo

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Tenant Configuration

Snapshot Managament



How ready is Configuration Management

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→ Snapshots
This is my tenant right now

- Retained for 7 days
- Can be downloaded for long-term retention
- *Can be used as a starting point for a baseline*

→ Baseline
This is my desired configuration

- Declarative JSON representation of the desired state
- Can be created from a snapshot and then edited
- Contains only the resources/properties you want to monitor

→ Monitor
Tell me when it no longer matches

- **Compares Actual State vs. Desired State every 6 hours**
- No built-in notifications or remediation
- Need *who / when / how?* → check Audit Logs

→ Configuration drift
Something changed

- Resource no longer matches the baseline
- Shows Current vs. Desired
- After remediation, the next run marks the drift as Fixed

Hard deleted? And now what?

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- Object must be recreated
- Object will become a new ID
- Previous JSON export required (EntraExporter)
- Example article on rebuilding a hard-deleted Administrative Unit on my blog
  https://nothingbutcloud.net/2025-08-30-DeletedEntraObjects/
- Microsoft cannot help



To make sure it never comes down to a restore

- ✓ Protect sensitive Groups with „PIM Protected Groups“
  ➜ possible, but should you?
- ✓ Restricted Management AU

Demo …

- ✓ Protected Actions for hard deletions

Demo …

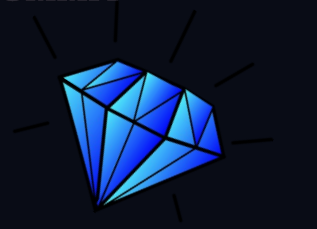
- ✓ Smart Alerting for important Resources
  Example implementation on my blog

https://nothingbutcloud.net/2025-12-16-ZeroTrust-Monitoring/



Summary: back to the “Agenda Questions”

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- ✓ Microsoft’s standpoint is clear
- ✓ It is up to the Tenant Admins to define what is important
- ✓ Regularly reassess your crown jewels: what is truly important, and choose the right backup approach



- ✓ Protective measures against configuration loss: *Who can do what?*
  Being proactive instead of reactive saves time and nerves



Further Resources ...



Microsoft Learn

Recoverability best practices (covers Microsoft standpoint in shared responsibility)

MS Learn: Recover from deletions

MS Learn: List deleted Item API Objects

MS Learn: Restore deleted Items and permissions

MS Learn: Application objects, service principals etc.

Use the unified tenant configuration management APIs in Microsoft Graph **(NEW)**

Microsoft Entra Backup and Recovery overview (Preview)

Best Practices & Community

Restricted management administrative units in Microsoft Entra ID



NothingButCloud Blog

Can I restore deleted Entra objects? Yes? No? Maybe?

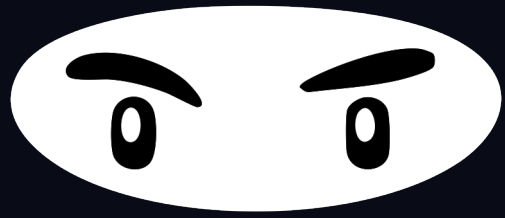
Protecting your Conditional Access Policies: Lean Backup Strategies for Entra ID

Thank You, Ninjas!



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See You Next Year!

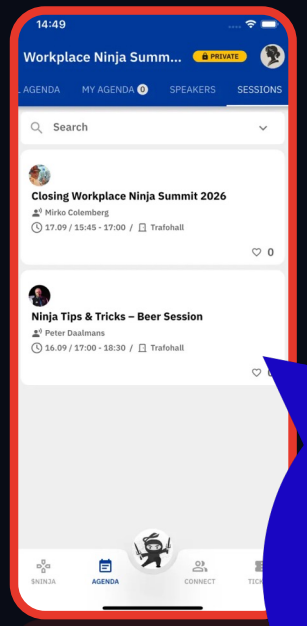


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